

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 369

By Freeman

A RESOLUTION to honor and commemorate the memory of
Father Charles Strobel.

WHEREAS, Father Charles Frederick Strobel was a Nashville native, who grew up in the Germantown neighborhood and fostered deep connections within the community and churches in the area; and

WHEREAS, Father Strobel believed in living his faith on a daily basis, pulling inspiration from the Sermon on the Mount, among other holy texts and divine inspirations; and

WHEREAS, upon becoming a priest, Father Strobel quickly and effectively set his sights on bettering the lives of the homeless and impoverished by opening up a facility for homeless people so they could have a warm place to stay at a time when endemic poverty and other social concerns were impacting Tennessee and the nation as a whole; and

WHEREAS, Father Strobel founded the Room in the Inn, a sanctuary opened in a church parking lot in the winter of 1985; and

WHEREAS, the Room in the Inn has since blossomed into a national model for assisting the homeless, with over 200 congregations and 7,000 volunteers sheltering nearly 1,500 individuals from November 1 to March 31 of each season; and

WHEREAS, this State seeks to honor Father Strobel and how he combated homelessness to enact positive change and created programs for the homeless that have become a successful model for the entire nation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that on March 13, 2025, we honor and commemorate the memory of Father

Charles Strobel, reflecting upon his mission, the valiant and noble strides he took to combat homelessness in Tennessee, and the positive impact his efforts have had nationwide.